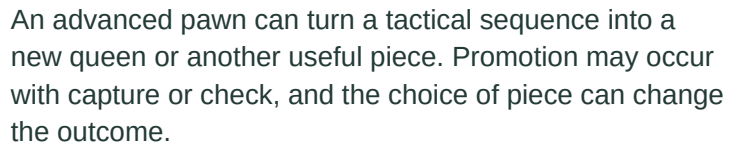


Promotion combinations

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on f4. Geometrically undefended: rook on e1. Check for tactical protection.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

52...Kxe1 The king captures the rook on e1. Recorded reply: **53.f6**.

53...c2 The pawn moves from c3 to c2. Recorded reply: **54.f7**.

54...c1=Q+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 3 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +13. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +13: the balance goes from -6 to +7. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.